Pick-a-Date Checklist

Fill in the top, pick your day with the calendar, then work through the prep checklist. Copy this sheet or relax with the rule of thumb: **two weekends of prep per sale.**

Sale month / season	_____
Today's date	_____
Backup sale date (rain plan)	_____

Choose your day

Compare four candidate weekends. The best garage-sale days are usually the **first Saturday of the month** (payday energy), mornings from 7 a.m. to noon, and weekends without local events or community-wide sales.

Candidate	Date	Conflicts? (weather, holiday, local events)	Pick it?
A			☐
B			☐
C			☐
D			☐

Three weeks before

- ☐ Pick the sale date and mark it on every calendar you use
- ☐ Walk the house and label a **donate** pile too
- ☐ Start filling tables one room at a time
- ☐ Decide which rooms are off-limits (close the door)

Two weeks before

- ☐ Price everything using the pricing cards or a marker
- ☐ Gather tables, blankets, racks, hangers, extension cords
- ☐ Fill the change fund (see the change-fund worksheet)
- ☐ Arrange any help for sale morning

Week of the sale

- ☐ Print signs and fill them in (Sheet 6)
- ☐ Sketch your table layout on Sheet 5
- ☐ Post it if your neighborhood allows it, walk the route and time it
- ☐ Sort items by table and print Sheet 3 labels

Night before

- [ ] Set up as much as possible tonight
- [ ] Cash box counted, change fund worksheet done
- [ ] Signs, tape, bags, pens, tally log in one tote
- [ ] Early to bed — buyers arrive early

Sale morning

- [ ] Signs up by 6:30–7:00 a.m., facing both directions
- [ ] Doors, gates, and the path from street to tables are safe and clear
- [ ] Tally log open on the payment table, first page ready
- [ ] Take a photo of the layout before it gets busy (great for next time)